Lora Anderson

Operational and Strategic Leader

linkedin.com/in/loraanderson410 | loraanderson410.github.io/professional-portfolio

Professional Summary

Cross-functional operations leader with experience driving business growth, strengthening financial governance, improving processes, and leading digital transformation across diverse organizations. Proven track record of scaling operations, establishing internal controls, developing organization-wide analytics and performance reporting, and improving underperforming business operations. Combines strong financial judgment, hands-on technology expertise, and analytical problem-solving to reduce costs, improve efficiency, and turn strategic priorities into measurable results.

Professional Experience

Operations Manager

Family Solutions | Ashland, OR | Aug 2022 - Sep 2026

Senior operations leader with cross-functional decision-making authority in a multi-site organization of approximately 50-60 employees.

- **Financial Management & Cost Control:** Reduced recurring operating expenses by more than $100,000 annually through vendor negotiations, contract reviews, and service utilization analysis.
- **Business Intelligence & Analytics:** Built the first organizational performance framework with 100+ KPIs, Power Query, SQL and Power BI reporting.
- **Process Improvement & Automation:** Developed automated financial allocations and administrative workflows using Excel, Power Query, and Power Automate.
- **Risk Management & Compliance:** Built automated review and approval tracking for approximately 300 organizational policies, establishing accountability for ownership, deadlines, and regulatory compliance.
- **Business Development & Grant Funding:** Prepared three successful competitive contract proposals and secured approximately $60,000 in grant awards.
- **Technology Leadership & Business Continuity:** Led IT operations, recovered administrative control of critical business systems, and strengthened access governance, security controls, and employee offboarding procedures.
- **Systems Implementation & Change Management:** Supported UKG Ready implementation, developed administrative workflows and training resources, and trained managers and employees to support system adoption.
- **Safety & Compliance Management:** Modernized a 15-year-old workplace safety program, coordinated an OSHA review, and strengthened facility inspections, emergency procedures, and compliance monitoring.

Human Resources Specialist

Friends of Children and Families | Orlando, Florida | Aug 2021 - Aug 2022

Owned full-cycle human resources (HR) operations for approximately 60–75 employees across seven geographically dispersed locations.

- **Human Resources Management:** Managed full-cycle recruiting, hiring, onboarding, employee relations, performance management, workforce administration, and regulatory compliance.
- **Employee Retention & Organizational Development:** Partnered with program leadership to redesign onboarding, structured training, mentoring, and 30/60/90-day employee check-ins, contributing to an approximately 65% reduction in regrettable attrition at one residential program.
- **Workforce Analytics & Reporting:** Analyzed employee turnover, staffing, training, and compliance trends, developing reports and presenting findings at every board meeting.
- **HRIS Implementation & Change Management:** Supported Paychex implementation, employee training, and system adoption while administering Relias LMS and developing training compliance workflows.

Business Office Manager

National Builders & Acceptance Corporation | Pittsburgh, PA | Jan 2017 - Apr 2021

Directed companywide operations with broad financial and strategic decision-making authority for a business managing more than 100 rental units.

- **Business Growth & Strategic Planning:** Doubled portfolio rental revenue through prioritized renovations, improved occupancy, and targeted marketing strategies.
- **Financial Governance & Business Transformation:** Rebuilt accounting records, financial processes, and internal controls following an ownership transition, strengthening budgeting, cash flow management, and financial reporting.
- **Project & Capital Management:** Directed three full-building renovations and multiple property improvements, overseeing budgets, contractors, schedules, and project cost tracking.
- **Business Systems Implementation & Analytics:** Led evaluation, selection, and implementation of HRIS and business management systems, and developed an Excel dashboard tracking approximately 50 financial, operational, and workforce KPIs.
- **People Leadership & Retention:** Led recruiting, employee relations, performance management, and workforce development, maintaining organizational stability with only two employee departures over four years
- **Business Continuity & Crisis Management:** Helped navigate COVID disruption through cash flow planning, PPP support, and a traveling healthcare worker strategy that created another market for vacant properties.

Workers Compensation Medical Care Case Manager

WorkWell | Carnegie, PA | Sep 2013 - Dec 2016

Managed complex workers' compensation cases and served as the dedicated case manager for Synergy Insurance.

- **Client Management & Risk Analysis:** Selected as dedicated case management contact for the company's largest client; managed 100+ complex cases and analyzed workplace injury trends to identify risks and prevention opportunities.

Operations Manager

PC Geeks | Enid, OK | Oct 2006 - Aug 2013

Directed companywide operations and five functional managers as the business expanded from an early-stage startup to approximately 40 employees.

- **Business Growth & Strategic Planning:** Helped expand the company into multiple service lines with hundreds of customer contracts, supporting its growth and eventual profitable acquisition.
- **Financial Management & Governance:** Directed budgeting, forecasting, P&L and cash flow management, purchasing, vendor negotiations, and financial controls with direct banking authority
- **People Leadership & Retention:** Built HR processes, developed supervisors, and led recruiting, employee relations, and performance management while maintaining annual employee turnover below 10%
- **Business Analysis & Systems Improvement:** Translated operational requirements into system enhancements, collaborating with technical teams to improve custom databases, applications, workflows, and reporting tools

Technology & Analytics

Analytics, Automation & AI: Power BI, Advanced Excel (VBA), Power Automate, Microsoft Copilot, ChatGPT

Databases, Data Tools & Enterprise Systems: SQL, MariaDB, Oracle, PeopleSoft, CareLogic, Power Query

Systems Administration: Microsoft 365, SharePoint, Intune, PowerShell, Google Workspace, UniFi/Ubiquiti, WordPress

HR, Learning & Financial Systems: UKG Ready, ADP, Paychex, Relias, QuickBooks Desktop/Online

Digital Operations & Collaboration: Shopify | Microsoft Teams | Slack | DocuSign | Adobe Acrobat | Microsoft Forms | Genuity

Education

Master of Behavioral Science | Northwestern Oklahoma State University | Alva, OK

Bachelor of Arts, Psychology and Business | Oklahoma State University | Stillwater, OK